Conservation The protection and preservation of animal life, plant life, and natural resources.

Consumer A species that eats other organisms to obtain its required nutrients; this term can apply to any organism that is not at the very bottom of the food chain

Deciduous Describes trees that shed their leaves in the fall.

Decomposers Organisms, primarily bacteria and fungi, that break down dead organisms and waste matter to obtain energy.

Deforestation The cutting down of a large area of trees, carried out for a range of purposes, including farming, industry, and construction.

Detritivores Organisms that feed on waste matter.

Diatom Any of a large group of microscopic algae that often play an important role in stabilizing an ecosystem and facilitating the existence of a range of life forms.

Diversity A measure of the variety of species within a biological community or ecosystem.

DNA Deoxyribonucleic acid. A large molecule in the shape of a double helix that carries genetic information in a chromosome.

Ecology The scientific study of the relationships between living organisms and their environment.

Ecosystem A community of organisms in a given environment that interact with and affect one another.

Endangered Describes a species whose population is so small that it is at risk of dying out completely.

Epidemiology The study of how diseases spread through populations, and the impact this has on the wider ecosystem.

Ethology The scientific study of the evolution of animal behavior as an adaptive trait, with a particular focus on observing animals in their natural